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# Contradiction Memo

## Assumption Being Challenged

Our business case that came out of our Sprint 2 frames a problem that students are finding out an item is sold out after they arrive. The first slice is being built around that: students see which locations are open, which items are available/sold out, and staff can get a digital dashboard or form that can be used to mark items sold out. The assumption is that “open” plus “sold out” is the information students are mostly missing and would find the most helpful.

The interviews suggest that sold-out status is one of several gaps but not the most common one to consider maybe.

## Contradicting Evidence

Interview 1 shows this in the clearest case; when the student walked to a cafe that was open, but its kitchen had already stopped serving food. The 12-minute walk and back to class without eating, shows that while nothing was sold out, and the location was open, the counter wasn’t serving. In our current slice, DineCheck would have shown this cafe as open with items, which would have still affected the student in a negative way regardless. The same student also mentioned going to a counter and not knowing “if they are still serving lunch.”

Interview 2 partly supports our assumption, as the vegetarian bowl was listed online but sold out. The same student’s other problem was the ingredients. They couldn’t find the ingredients for a sauce online, so they were forced to eat a different meal. When the online menu and the counter sign described the item differently, asking an employee because neither of them was trustworthy.

Interview 3 did run into a sold-out item since the cafe had no desserts left, but the student called it minor and just went to a coffee shop. The real issue being hours that change on specific dates. The maps listing showed normal hours while campus announcements showed holiday hours, and the student would not be sure cafe would be open during coffee break. Being a graduate student at this university I have had experience with emails that denote extended or special hours for dining options in campus, but (again in my personal experience) these have not always been consistent; so this interview was of particular note to me as I had failed to consider this.

Across three interviews, the one sold out case cost a student something was the vegetarian bowl. Other problems that mattered were counter stopped serving while location was technically open, unclear ingredients and special university hours/events.

## Why this Matters

If we build only "open" and "sold-out" as options, DineCheck can still send students on the trip that failed in Interview 1. That is the problem we are trying to solve, and it also weakens our main difference from the UTEP Dining site, which already shows what's open and has menus

and dietary filters. It also affects the estimate. Our function points and use cases count one staff input (mark sold out). A counter stopped serving status is a small addition, but ingredient accuracy is a bigger content problem that our slice doesn't cover, and our budget doesn't price.

**My Advice**

I recommend we change the slice's status model from two states to three: location open, counter serving, and item available, each with the time it was last updated. Staff would mark a counter as "stopped serving" with the same one-tap action we planned for sold-out items, so the extra cost should be small (no more training). We should re-check the function point count before claiming that.

Ingredient information should be recorded as a known need outside this slice, not quietly added. Holiday and break hours should be tested against the UTEP site first, since it may already handle them.  Before the next sprint, we should ask in our next interviews which of these problems happened most recently and what they cost them. Until then, the business case should say students can't confirm what is actually being served rather than items sold out.